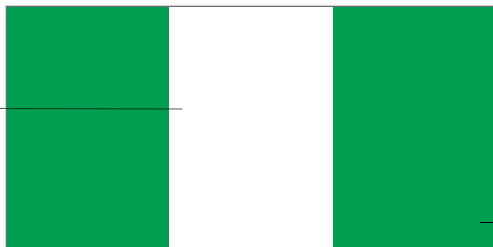


Nigeria

Ratio: 1:2 **Adopted:** October 1, 1960 **Usage:** National

White
symbolizes
peace and
unity



Green recalls
the land

Africa



Nigeria was formed in 1914 from several British colonies and protectorates. In 1954 it became a federation and in 1960 achieved independence.

The national flag is an adaptation of the winning entry in a competition held in 1959. The original had a red sun with streaming rays placed at the top of the white stripe. This was removed by the judges and the flag has not been altered since.

Like Ghana, Nigeria has special flags for civil and naval vessels and at

one time the states also had flags.

The coat of arms was granted in 1960, but the motto has been altered since then to include the words “Peace and Progress.” The shield represents the confluence of two rivers and the crest is a red eagle. It all stands on a green base strewn with the *Coctus spectabilis* flower.

ARMS OF NIGERIA

The confluence
of the Niger and
Benuë rivers

The *Coctus
spectabilis* is the
national flower



The red eagle
symbolizing strength
is the national badge

The two white
horses symbolize
dignity

The national motto—
“Unity and Faith,
Peace and Progress”